



MONTHLY UPDATE

Digital Identity and CRVS: monthly update, August 2026

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40 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

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The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The unified national digital identity is being used as a single sign-on, and the record's first evidence of that is a sectoral one. On 12 August the sports ministry [integrated its platforms into the national services portal so that holders of the credential reach its WADHIFATI platform without registering again](#). The credential is issued by the Haut Commissariat a la Numerisation; no enrolment count, assurance level, governing instrument or data-protection basis for it is held, so what a reader can establish is that it works across two systems, not how many people hold it or on what legal footing.

Angola

On 28 July the justice ministry [launched an at-home service priced at Kz 250,000](#) for processing and Kz 10,000 for delivery alone, in one province only, the minister justifying the fee as a product of exclusivity.

The single digital identity, named as a workstream since 2024 and as [a component of the US\\$150m public digital infrastructure contract in June](#), acquired a price and a procurement. [Despacho Presidencial 300/26 of 13 August authorised US\\$28m and opened the public tender](#) for a National Digital Identity and Electronic Signatures Platform, specified to support up to 30 million digital identities and to let citizens, firms and public officials use one digital credential for public services, digital contracts, electronic verification of customers and legally valid electronic signatures. No supplier, timetable, or relationship to the earlier contract is stated.

The territorial administration ministry is updating the voter register at a religious pilgrimage, [stationing brigades at the Muxima sanctuary from 29 August to 6 September under the 2026-2027 official electoral registration, with more than a million citizens already enrolled for the 2027 general election](#); pilgrims need an identity card or voter card to take part.

Benin

The identity agency wants to analyse what it holds. It [opened a tender for the architecture of a business-intelligence environment over its national identity data](#). Analytics over a population register raises the question of what the analysis is for and who may run it; the tender notice in the record held does not answer either, and no purpose limitation is stated.

Botswana

The credential's problem this month is forgery rather than production. The labour and home affairs ministry [is contending with a cartel producing fake identity documents](#). That is a statement about the integrity of the Omang credential, not only about the backlog in issuing it, and the two compound each other: a slow replacement queue is what makes a forged card useful. No arrest, prosecution or volume figure is in the record held.

Burkina Faso

The Sahel alliance's shared credential reached another town. Enrolment for the common biometric identity card [opened in Arbinda on 27 August](#). Arbinda is in the Soum province, which makes where enrolment opens a security question as much as an administrative one. The record held carries no enrolment total for the card, in Burkina Faso or across the alliance.

Burundi

Biometric civil registration is [operating in 13 pilot communes, decentralised to zone level and interoperable with health-facility birth and death records, with a national unique identifier planned on fingerprint and facial biometrics](#). The health-facility link is the part with numbers behind it: the interior ministry says it has been [piloted since 2023, institutionalised in 2024, and now runs in 123 health facilities where it has recorded more than 52,000 births](#). No coverage denominator is given for either figure.

It is being built onto a base that already reaches most children: [84% of under-fives are registered at birth and 66% hold a birth certificate](#), cited by government on Africa Civil Registration Day. The gap between the two figures is the one the platform has to close.

Cameroon

Two identity operations ran in the month, both municipal. On 27 July [4,000 free identity cards were handed over at Yaoundé 5](#), some to recipients blocked for over fifteen years by duplicate-identity records, cleared by seconding police officers on site; the operation was timed to public-service and police recruitment competitions, for which the card is a precondition. From 3 July, [compulsory registration of taxi owners and drivers opened on a city platform](#), with a QR code and a unique door number per driver and unregistered taxis barred after 5 October.

The register underneath both is only now being equipped. On 7 August the United Nations development programme [opened a tender for the equipment of three pilot centres digitising civil-status registration](#). Three centres is the whole of the stated scope, and the notice names neither their locations nor a value or timetable — against a paper record the base elsewhere shows being used to draw fraudulent payroll claims.

Chad

The identity agency stated its own position for the first time in the base, [describing a system that assigns every enrolled individual a unique national identification number across 29 centres](#). What it does not give is a number: no enrolment total and no coverage rate, so the three per cent holding a card at appraisal in 2023 has no successor.

Comoros

At the African civil registration day in Moroni on 10 August, the interior minister and the modernisation project's coordinator [tied digitised birth registration, particularly for newborns in rural communities, to legal identity, with the children's fund reaffirming support](#). It is a restatement of intent rather than a system: no registration rate is on record at either end of the window, and the civil-status agency the 2023 law provides for is still a draft decree.

Congo

The credential layer moved on stock rather than on design: the government [announced 100,000 blank passports and a new payment mechanism, alongside 330,000 identity cards](#). The instrument behind the card is older — [Decret 2024-2692 of 21 November 2024 institutes the computerised national identity card](#) — and the unique identification number it rests on has been instituted since 2004. What the base still does not hold is an issuance series against those volumes.

DR Congo

Identification in the window is a provincial operation rather than a national one. Training of the agents for an operation registering Mbororo herders in Nord-Ubangi [closed at Gbadolite on 17 August](#). Registering a named population as a distinct category is a decision with consequences beyond the register, and no legal basis, data controller, retention rule or purpose limitation is published for it.

Continentially, the laboratory system the country's current Ebola response runs on was assessed before the outbreak began. A multi-country study [covering 26 countries found every one with a functioning surveillance system and core diagnostic capacity and 3,964 laboratories mapped across fourteen, and named digital interoperability between laboratories and surveillance platforms — alongside specimen referral, workforce surge and domestic financing — as the weak points](#), which is where the response has had to improvise. It is a reference study written up by its own author rather than a dated development here, and the base holds no national laboratory-interoperability position to set against it.

Egypt

Identity gained a second biometric front end and a liability problem in the same month. The central bank governor launched [Haweya, registering face and fingerprint biometrics and enabling remote account opening at 37 banks](#), and the [national identity application reached a second release adding liveness detection](#). Neither carries an enrolment count or a governing decree. Against that, the telecommunications regulator [stated that registration alone does not establish criminal liability](#) after lines were found registered to people without their knowledge, after reports of a nineteen-year-old sentenced in absentia to 25 years in a case turning on a line registered in his name in 2024; it says it is revising the rules towards biometric subscriber verification, with no date or target stated. Within a week the revision acquired shape: the regulator [tightened the registration rules, referred the four mobile operators to the prosecution and set a unified national digital-identity project alongside](#), and is [expanding mandatory facial verification at enrolment through its know-your-customer system, linked to the civil registry](#). Verification at enrolment does not prevent a line being handed on afterwards, which is the gap the case turned on. The scale of the

problem showed in the complaint traffic: the regulator [logged over 3,000 line-fraud complaints and 100,000 call-centre inquiries in two days](#), saying it checks each disputed registration against the provider's own records. What the fix itself costs is now being asked in public: a member of parliament [has pressed the government on what institutional framework governs collection, storage and access to the facial-recognition data taken at registration](#), and digital-rights researchers argue that [biometric data cannot be reissued once compromised, which makes the protection framework the precondition rather than the sequel](#). The health ministry is separately [stated to have taken birth and death registration electronic nationwide](#), on the development plan's own word and with no coverage rate published.

The telecoms regulator [launched a remote biometric verification system in a pilot phase](#), built with ITIDA, CyShield and licensed electronic-signature companies, letting users reach services requiring identity verification and electronic signatures through mobile applications rather than company branches. Operators are to enable it in their own apps as their technical readiness allows, and its stated scope is to widen later to a broader range of digital services.

Eswatini

The home affairs ministry [asked citizens to check that the chief code on their identity documents matches their actual chieftom](#), warning that an incorrect code creates difficulty in reaching government services. Six months after card production resumed from a technical suspension, the maintenance question has moved from the machine to the record.

Ethiopia

The identity programme supplied most of the month's movement: a [joint venture with Safaricom and a local partner](#) on 6 July to run mass registration across seven regions, and, on 24 July, the operator's own disclosure that it accounts for 69% of all registrations, with more than 4m farmers enrolled through the agriculture ministry and more than 28,000 displaced people through humanitarian partners.

At the same 24 July launch of a three-year strategic plan, its deputy director in the capital named premature integration as the year's main obstacle and its founding director general conceded the platform remains intertwined with decades-old institutional systems of undefined standards. The identity layer meanwhile acquired a corporate owner: the Faydaverse digital-public-infrastructure enterprise was inaugurated on 4 August as a state-owned enterprise under Ethiopian Investment Holdings, on a platform [reported at over 190 million authentications performed and 150 enterprises integrated for biometric checks](#). No governing instrument, board or commercial model for the enterprise is published.

Four days later that enterprise set out where the credential goes next. Its wallet is [to carry academic transcripts, professional licences, healthcare records, property titles and financial-compliance and know-your-customer data beyond the core government credentials it holds today](#), and the enterprise says it is exporting identity services as an implementation partner in Mozambique and Zambia. The plan and the export claims are its own; no timetable, consent model, data-controller arrangement or regulatory approval for the additional credential types is stated.

Enrolment passed a further mark at the close of the period. The programme [put registrations at 49.1m on 24 August, on 12,000 biometric registration kits deployed and 150 agencies integrated, with more than 194m eKYC verifications performed against the register](#). The counts are the programme's own and unaudited, and the [prime-ministerial expectation that the credential will contribute 7% of GDP by 2030](#) is stated alongside them as a projection rather than a measurement. The reporting outlet's "90 million by 2027" is its own framing: the programme's target is 90m by 2028.

What is not on the record is the counterweight. A published critique argues the system risks becoming an instrument of mass profiling in the absence of independent data-protection impact assessments, meaningful citizen rights and legal limits on state access, against the registrations above, up from 16.4m in June 2025, and a 90m target. The base holds no such assessment, no redress mechanism and no statutory access limit, and that absence is now recorded as a gap.

The enrolment rules reached the base for the first time, which matters more than the enrolment count for anyone trying to work out who can be enrolled. The programme's own page lists 33 accepted proof-of-identity documents, from the local administration card and passport to birth, education, marriage and business records, and a separate account sets out what non-citizens must present: an origin card and passport for foreign nationals of Ethiopian origin, a residence or work permit plus passport for other foreign residents, and a valid refugee card for recognised refugees. Neither carries its own issue date, so both are dated to capture — and the refugee route stated here is the operative counterpart to the refugee-inclusion framework the base already holds.

Gambia

The National Identity Management System went live on 1 July 2026, issuing GAM ID cards on the spot, with nationwide enrolment from 4 August 2026. On 7 August the interior ministry began a nationwide rollout of new ten-year biometric national identity cards, with registration opening simultaneously at six centres, produced with a Ghana-based supplier. No enrolment or issuance figure has been published since launch, so the system's reach is unestablished.

The rollout got the calendar the base had been missing. The government published the phased schedule and fee structure: registration extends to Sibanor and Jarra Soma on 7 September, to Barra, Kerewan, Farafenni and Kaur on 11 September and to Janjanbureh, Basse and Fatoto on 21 September, with a first-time card at D450 waived during the rollout for holders of a valid immigration department card. An applicant with no passport, birth certificate or prior document must be vouched for by both the Alkalo and the Seyfo of their place of residence.

What the identity system replaced is now documented from two sides, and the backfill matters more than the launch. A lender diagnostic finds fragmented mandates, no universal coverage and weak interoperability across the identity estate, and a newspaper account describes a processing centre in Kanifing shut when its electricity bill went unpaid, on a foreign-run biometric system in place since 2018 at a D450 fee. Against that, the system went live on 29 June 2026 with the President as its first enrollee, under a public-private partnership between the interior ministry and the card supplier.

Ghana

The identity regulator publicised amendment regulations on 16 July that had come into force on 9 June, and the interior minister then set the enforcement date: banks, telecoms operators, hospitals, schools, insurers and agencies have a three-month transition from 27 July to 2 November 2026 to install readers and integrate with the verification service, on a sanctions ladder running to suspension of access and licence withdrawal. Verification tied to SIM registration is explicitly excluded, with no timetable announced.

The first paid round-the-clock identity centre opened on 1 August with all services attracting approved charges and no fee schedule published; by 13 August the agency described the Labone centre as running registration on three shifts around the clock, presented as part of the government's wider 24-hour economy programme. No throughput or staffing figure is published, and the base holds no equivalent extension of the free daytime service.

The central bank republished its standing directive on 2 September: under regulation 7 of the 2012 national identity register regulations, [the card has been the only identification accepted for transactions at every institution the bank licenses and regulates since 1 July 2022](#). The base had carried that requirement only from a January 2026 guidance note. Dated four years earlier, it makes the photocopy ban an enforcement step against a rule already long in force rather than a new obligation.

The SIM half of the identity regime moved for the first time in nine months. The minister said on 7 September that [Parliament has passed the legislative instrument governing SIM registration and the biometric verification phase will be introduced before the end of 2026](#), the same account putting completion of the 2021-2023 exercise it replaces at 44.28% of subscribers. What has moved is the authority to act: no start date, enrolment route or subscriber deadline is published and the instrument itself is not held.

Guinea

Four days later, Multimédia Glory Guinée — the state's own technical partner deploying the biometric civil-registration system — [stated publicly that fees not provided for in the regulations were being taken at enrolment centres, that a pay-for-priority tier operated, and that citizens were unaware the documents are free](#). It asked two ministries for unannounced inspections, sanctions, an information campaign and a reporting line; neither had responded at publication.

On 10 August the territorial administration minister [put birth registration at 72% in 2025 against 54% in 2022, and said a unique personal identification number was being put in place alongside digitalisation of the civil-status system](#). The figures are the minister's own, given at a commemorative event with no statistical source named, and the identification number still has no instrument, issuing authority, format or enrolment figure on record.

Kenya

Government is [procuring a system to cut identity-card issuance to ten days and passports to a week](#). The source is a headline account; no contract, vendor or value is held.

Two identity systems met the courts instead. The High Court [barred the transport authority from discontinuing physical vehicle logbooks](#) on 11 August, pending a petition arguing the electronic logbook was introduced without public participation and without adequate data-protection and cybersecurity impact assessments. Separately, the Attorney-General's six-month window to legislate on phone-number recycling, opened by the March judgment recognising a registered number as a protected digital identifier, [was still open in August with nothing tabled](#), while banks, savings societies and platforms continue to rely on numbers after reassignment.

The transport and safety authority's own disclosure notice under the PPP Act settles the smart driving licence partnership the base had held only in summary: a twenty-one-year Strategic Partnership with [a KCB Bank Limited and Pesa Print consortium, estimated at KSh 42bn over its first two to three years and funded entirely from private debt and equity, approved by Cabinet on 15 December 2025 after the Attorney-General cleared the draft agreement in January](#). It is to issue 5 million polycarbonate cards every three years, stand up 102 enrolment centres, install 700 fixed and 300 mobile speed cameras behind a national command centre, and carry a licence wallet taking deposits and payments. The project began in 2017 with the National Bank of Kenya and passed to KCB by novation after Access Bank bought NBK. No financial close or first issuance date is named.

Lesotho

A freeze on refugee identity documents is reported to have left [families stranded and bank accounts frozen](#). Where an identity system is the gate to banking, an administrative freeze is a financial exclusion as well as a documentary one; no instrument, affected count or review route is on file.

Liberia

The identity build reached the legislature. The National Identification Registry says [procurement of an Austrian firm to build a new biometric identification system under a public-private partnership is complete, and the concession agreement is with the President ahead of legislative ratification](#); a day later, [consultations on the draft agreement had concluded and it had gone to Parliament for approval](#), with the registry stating it will disclose the terms only once ratification is complete and officials saying issuance will be free for poor first-time applicants. Mass enrolment has been suspended since 23 June 2025, so the country has been more than a year without one, and coverage stands [below 15% of a population above five million](#). No concession value, term, revenue model or data-protection provision is published.

A second identity register is being built outside the state entirely. On 16 August the commercial motorcycle and tricycle riders' union and a private digital services company [signed a memorandum to build a digital identity, GPS tracking and a rider database](#), aimed at curbing vehicle theft and linking informal-sector riders to formal financial and government services. It covers continuous location tracking of a working population, and no data-protection basis, custodian, retention rule or consent mechanism is reported for it.

Libya

An independent count put a figure on what the enforcement is chasing. A data analysis built on 66 official publications of the Attorney General's office to April 2026 [found 278,969 nationality files exposed to forgery over a 43-year window, with 10,620 families and more than 4,000 individuals implicated, and named five mechanisms from insertion of records into family registers to direct manipulation of the registry database](#). It is an outside analysis of published prosecutions rather than an official audit, and no state response to the count is held.

Malawi

The registration bureau reported on 13 July 2026 that more than 13.5 million people hold a national digital identity, with over 150,000 enrolled between April and June, 53% of them women ([registration bureau](#)). On 6 July it [set the forthcoming mobile credential's launch for September 2026](#), and on 5 August a separate distributed-ledger wallet was stated to be in pilot; neither announcement names the other.

Using the system got more expensive. The bureau [raised fees for national identity card replacement, electronic know-your-customer verification, civil registration and marriage services](#) under the National Registration (Amendment) Regulations 2026, gazetted on 31 July. The fee levels and their previous values are not in the record held, so the size of the increase is not established. The charge for electronic know-your-customer verification is a charge on third parties for using the identity system, levied in the month the bureau reported approaching universal coverage.

Mauritania

The identity application is now load-bearing, and the month showed what that means. It [carries about 1.5 million citizens and 554,027 remote services, and underpins identity verification for the state services portal's fifteen-plus services and for private financial applications](#) — and a full day of scheduled maintenance on 8 August took all of it down at once. The usage figures are the reporting outlet's; no operator statement on the outage or on redundancy is held.

Mozambique

The humanitarian register moved from pilot to a dated launch. Validation of the beneficiary and humanitarian assistance management system [was completed with national launch stated for October 2026](#), the platform built to interoperate with the national social-support database so that duplicate and fictitious beneficiary registrations can be curbed. No data-protection basis, retention rule or enrolment target is published.

Separately the government [opened discussions with a local partner on a mobile digital identity and electronic-signature platform](#). Discussions are the stage reached: no contract, scope or date is held.

Namibia

The identity ministry reported on 23 July that it printed 166,237 identity documents between 1 April 2025 and 30 June 2026 of which 125,999 were collected, leaving 40,238 uncollected, and that a school registration drive had reached 24 of 55 target schools ([ministry figures](#)).

The regional outreach opened in Omaheke on 27 July and ran to 5 August across all seven constituencies, delivered with a development agency and the regulator ([outreach account](#)). The regional governor said marginalised communities need to be convinced to take up the card, and the ministry team named low literacy as the obstacle to understanding it ([governor's account](#)).

Alongside the outreach runs a [Youth e-ID Ambassadors Programme, using young people to promote take-up of the credential and civic participation](#). Participant numbers, cost, duration and any effect on enrolment are unstated, and the funding agency's own account is the only one the base holds.

Niger

The identification agency exists in law. It [was created by decree of 22 April 2026, with its statutes approved by a companion decree](#), and a national awareness tour is taking the civil-status and identification reforms to the regions, officially launched at Dosso on 14 August. No enrolment figure, budget or operating date for the agency is published, so what has moved is the instrument and not yet the register.

Nigeria

Identity gained infrastructure and kept its gap. The passport became [cryptographically verifiable at 111 member states' borders](#) on 16 July; the identity authority [took the national root certification authority over from NITDA](#) on 21 July; and [V-Pass went live](#) for airport security checks and boarding on the number and face biometrics. Registration stands at [136 million against a target of 180 million by 31 December](#), leaving about 100 million people uncaptured on the information minister's own figure. The root certification authority it took over also created a conflict: the NIMC Act 2026 makes the identity commission the root authority while the [still-pending Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill carries its own electronic-signature provisions](#), and which instrument governs digital signatures is unresolved.

Two identity systems moved in opposite directions. The federal government [signed a memorandum on 12 August to issue cooperatives a verification number and their members an identity credential, opening a six-month revalidation exercise](#), with no cooperative or member count, cost, or link to the foundational register stated. Against that, an observer mission at the state governorship election of 15 August [called for a full post-election technical audit of the biometric voter-accreditation system, for the electoral commission to publish the causes of authentication failures, and for uniform guidance on downloadable voter cards before 2027](#). A second observer group reporting on the same poll [named the failure modes — devices that would not boot, delaying one unit's opening to 09:45, fingerprint and facial capture failing on voters, elderly voters recurrently, so that they could not vote at all, slow processing at units of over 1,100 registered voters, an export failure, and one device that stopped altogether](#), and asked for the devices to be upgraded before 2027. Both accounts are observers' own, limited to the units their teams visited; no commission response, failure rate or audit commitment is on record.

The identity count was split in two on 7 September, and the halves do not agree with what anyone had been quoting. The lender's own implementation report puts [117,493,554 people holding a number out of 134,553,120 enrolments at 30 June 2026, against a target of 180,000,000 by December](#) — a 17-million gap between enrolling and being issued that the base had been carrying as a single figure. Closing the remaining gap would need [monthly enrolment to rise from 1.5–1.8 million to about 7.4 million with six months left](#). Five days earlier the commission had put its own count at [about 140 million, alongside enrolment time cut from seven days to one hour](#), in the course of describing itself under the 2026 Act as a national trust authority rather than an identity register. Three numbers, none reconciled.

The same report rates the project [Moderately Satisfactory on both progress and implementation at Substantial overall risk, with the system-integrator contract for the modular open-source rebuild awarded and an implementation period of about eighteen months](#).

A second use for election hardware was floated rather than agreed: the admissions board [asked the electoral commission for biometric verification machines that sit idle between elections, and the commission ordered a proof of concept on whether they are fit for it](#). No device count, transfer basis or data-protection assessment is published, and the two registers rest on separate legal bases.

Rwanda

The social registry has run an appeals process since it opened in early 2024, and [360,000 people challenged their category, with 93% of disputed classifications corrected](#). Disputes trace largely to stale asset records — unrecorded land or vehicle sales — and the correction rate is the social affairs directorate's own.

Senegal

Consolidated agency data at 17 July records [437 of 629 civil-status centres fully deployed, 112 of them running the citizen-facing service](#); on 13 July the agency reported [15.3m records loaded](#).

Deployment moved again in August, and the agency put a frame around it. At African Civil Registration Day in Kaolack on 10 August it [launched phase four of its remediation plan and put deployment at 74% of centres, up from 70% five days earlier, with the citizen request platform live in 189 communes](#), phase four extending to Kaffrine and Tambacounda; its director-general described civil registration as an instrument of sovereignty.

Sierra Leone

Identity took three public positions in four days. MoCTI [convened a national dialogue on digital identity and digital public infrastructure on 5 August](#), describing it as the first of a series and as the beginning of the policy work rather than its result. A private-sector consultation the following day settled two specifications: the register being built on is MOSIP-based, and the credentials envisaged under the Bhutan National Digital Identity and SIGN Foundation partnership are W3C-compliant verifiable credentials. On 7 August the NCRA Director-General told the consultation that the biometric register already covers about 93% of the population with a unique National Identification Number and a live eKYC platform, and that the Authority's own MOSIP pilot is complete but unfunded for full implementation — and warned against parallel identity systems being built alongside it.

In a 4 August ministerial statement responding to the mobile-money fraud surge, the communications minister [conceded the NIN-SIM linkage does not yet cover every subscriber](#).

Somalia

Cabinet [approved a third-generation e-passport plan on 6 August](#). No issuance date is published, and it follows the clearance in February to adopt and print the East African Community e-passport.

South Africa

Absa [joined the bank-branch smart identity channel](#), which the department put at 296 branches and more than 385,000 applications in four months; Operation Vulindlela's quarterly report [gave 203,887 applications across 171 branches](#). The reference periods differ and the figures have not been reconciled. Mobile operators and the justice department agreed a framework to [replace document presentation in SIM registration with real-time departmental verification](#). The base has since taken in a submission made on the closing day of the draft Identification Regulations' comment period on 6 June, in which a research organisation asked the department to suspend the regulations pending a published digital identity policy, an enacted National Identification and Registration Bill and demonstrated compliance with the data-protection Act, on the ground that they build biometric enrolment, trusted-entity accreditation and real-time verification with no formal role for the Information Regulator. The submission is held as a supplied document with no published address, so it cannot be linked to a reader.

On 29 July the Western Cape High Court [held four categories of exclusion in the birth-registration regulations unconstitutional](#), allowing 18 months for amendment and holding that the orders required no Constitutional Court confirmation.

Home Affairs reported that its electronic travel authorisation had [refused more than 5,500 travellers](#) since October 2025. It then left the pilot: the system [went live at OR Tambo, Cape Town, King Shaka and Lanseria from 12 August, with 6,126 fraudulent applications rejected — put at 2.8% of pilot submissions — and full visa-type rollout targeted by year-end](#). The department publishes no statistical series, and the four rejection counts it has given this year rest on bases that do not reconcile.

By mid-August the branch channel had a locator of its own. The department [launched a My Home Affairs Online portal on 17 August to help citizens find a participating branch, putting the network at 372 branches and more than half a million users to date](#), and framing it with the electronic travel authorisation as a building block of the national digital public infrastructure roadmap. Its own downtime statement a week earlier put the branch count above 408; the two are not reconciled. The travel authorisation itself [drew industry questions over its R500 fee and the adequacy of consultation](#) after its airport launch.

The draft digital-identity regulations drew their sharpest technical criticism yet. A published argument holds that they [under-specify verifier authentication, transparency about the purpose of a request, and enforcement of data minimisation](#), and urges binding rules requiring a requesting party to prove who it is, state why it is asking, and log every share — so that accountability falls on institutions rather than on the citizen who consented.

The department put a number on the fraud it is chasing. The minister [said about 300,000 identity documents have been blocked behind court orders where duplicates or people illegally in the country were detected](#), that the great majority of identity-theft cases involve the manual green identity book still held by about 16 million people, and that [the answer is expanding the smart card and the electronic travel authorisation](#).

South Sudan

The World Bank published its ID4D country diagnostic on 22 July 2026, putting [close to 90% of the population without any government-recognised identification](#). It records that obtaining the Nationality Certificate, the prerequisite for the identity card, requires costly age assessments or blood tests and travel to centralised offices, so most people acquire neither.

On 28 July the civil-registry directorate's plan also included [a digital national identity card to be issued to every citizen aged 18 and over as the gateway to bank accounts](#), delivery running through the health, justice and interior ministries with unnamed partners. It is [stated as intent only](#): no law, budget, timetable, vendor or platform is named.

The directorate says a [new-generation passport will be introduced in August 2027](#), moving the holder's occupation off the printed page into the digital system; raising ordinary validity from five to ten years, and issuing the East African Community passport, would each require amending the passport act, and no legislative timetable is given. It also [received 37,500 further passport booklets, putting stock at enough to sustain issuance to December 2026](#) with processing at about three days, and in Greater Yei [over 4,000 national identity cards began being collected on 13 July](#).

The directorate changed hands on 9 August, and both officeholders put numbers on the record. The outgoing director [put stock at about 32,000 passport booklets and 172,000 national identity cards, alongside 100 new mobile registration kits, a Nairobi memorandum toward an integrated civil registration system, and adult passport validity extended to ten years](#) — claims made at his own handover about his own tenure. His successor [put annual applicants above one million and delays at about a month](#), pledging faster and corruption-free issuance.

The largest registration actually carried out in the window was not the state's. The migration agency ran a [biometric registration and re-registration exercise across the Malakal protection-of-civilians site, the Bulakat transit centre and the Bentiu displacement camp, serving about 160,000 people between April and June](#), and its community-feedback data records an 1,100% rise in queries over the quarter, driven almost entirely by that exercise. No data-controller arrangement, retention rule, consent record or relationship to the national identity system is stated for it.

Sudan

The national digital identity system acquired a use case that makes it consequential, and the consequence lands on bank accounts. On 12 August the central bank [ordered banks to suspend and freeze customer accounts not updated by 30 September](#), under anti-money-laundering and counter-terrorist-financing data-verification requirements. Five days later it [extended the deadline to the end of 2026 and named the rollout of the national digital identity system as the route by which customers are to update their data](#).

Bankers backed the directive as necessary for the banking system's soundness while warning that freezing non-compliant accounts risks financial exclusion amid war-driven displacement and lost documentation. The directive text is not held; no count of accounts affected, no exception for displaced customers without documents and no appeal route is stated. Nor is any enrolment figure held for the identity system itself — so account continuity is being tied to a credential whose coverage is unmeasured, which is the exclusion risk the base recorded before it launched.

Tanzania

The identity register is the most heavily integrated rail the base holds anywhere, and its coverage is flat. Over 138 public and private institutions are integrated across banking, insurance and social security — the hardest adoption figure the base carries for any African identity-verification rail. Against that, the register stands at 26.4m registered, 22.3m numbers issued and 20.6m cards physically distributed, about 81% of eligible adults at December 2025: counts up, percentage flat to slightly down against a growing adult denominator. The gap between numbers issued and cards in citizens' hands is 1.7m, and it did not close over the period.

The budget behind it was set out to Parliament on 19 August: the home affairs ministry put the identifier's rollout among its 2026/27 priorities under the national blueprint, alongside new district registration offices and a headquarters at Dodoma. No cost line or timetable accompanies the priority.

Togo

Enrolment now goes to people rather than waiting for them. The documentation directorate has spent about a year sending mobile identity-card teams to large public gatherings, handling every step of an application on site, aiming to shorten processing times and put a card in the hands of the majority of Togolese by 2028. No count of cards issued through the mobile teams is published, so the register's own figure — more than six million unique identification numbers at the end of 2025 — remains the only measure of how far the effort has got.

What no amount of enrolment has produced is a way to use the credential: there is still no citizen account or single sign-on, and June's examination-results service asked candidates to pre-register by e-mail and table number rather than to sign in.

Tunisia

From 1 July 2026 the mobile identity became a condition of transacting with the state: the investment authority made it mandatory for all investment-project declarations.

The health identifier's provenance became public on 27 July 2026. A ministry adviser confirmed that the identifier built for Covid-19 vaccination, holding records of over 3 million childhood immunisations, was adopted as the national health identifier and bound to the national identity card, the social security number and school and university identifiers. Roughly 100,000 medical files had been linked. On protection of that linked dataset the ministry asserts only that data is stored confidentially and securely.

A second identifier moved a step behind it. At a ministerial session at La Kasbah on 18 August the government decided to upgrade the social identifier system, digitise social-security cards and services and put interconnected systems in place for real-time data exchange between the social funds, health structures and insured persons, with drafting of the reform texts to begin immediately. The communique states no timetable, no legal basis for the identifier and no scope.

Uganda

The identity authority put its own constraint on the record on 7 August: it is [operating at 70% of its approved workforce, with 25 districts served by a single member of staff and two board seats vacant](#). The figures were given to the internal affairs minister alongside a request for a permanent headquarters and additional wage funding.

Four days later the Auditor General's account of the same authority reached the press, and it puts a size on the consequence. As at late October 2025 [17 million citizens were still awaiting national identity cards, only 0.2% of first-time applicants had been cleared for printing, the staff vacancy rate stood at 26% and identity renewal faced a UGX256.8bn funding shortfall](#) — reported amid cross-district queue chaos over collection of new cards. The figures are ten months old at publication, and the authority publishes no current backlog series against which to test them.

The Cabinet decision of 1 September was narrowed twice in the week after it. The finance minister said on 3 September that it [does not make the identification number the taxpayer number but requires the two to be interoperable](#) — "we are not saying the NIN is the TIN; we are saying the NIN and the TIN must be able to read each other", and the revenue authority added on 7 September that [holding an identification number does not by itself make its holder a taxpayer](#), the purpose being a single secure identifier for government services and more accurate taxpayer records. The decision itself is not held, and no instrument, commencement date or migration plan has been published for what is now described as two identifiers reading each other rather than one replacing the other.

Zambia

The national authentication service is described by the body that runs it. The state technology institute [publishes it as an operational national authentication and access-control service, with single sign-on, OpenID Connect, multi-factor authentication and passwordless credentials for electronic government services](#). Named protocols and a running service are a stronger artefact than most identity positions on this ledger; the page carries no date, so the position is dated to retrieval, and no user count, uptime figure or list of relying services is published.

Zimbabwe

A deputy registrar general told a meeting of African registrars general on 24 July that electronic passport enrolment centres operate in ten districts, eight provincial centres and one abroad, with seven-day issuance away from the capital ([meeting account](#)).

The registration end of the same estate is being rebuilt with donor money. [Ten civil registry sub-offices across eight districts are being computerised, digitalised and solar-powered under a China-funded project with UNICEF](#), to widen birth-registration access in underserved communities through mobile registration and outreach alongside existing water, sanitation and nutrition platforms. No value, timetable, district list or birth-registration baseline is stated, so there is nothing to measure the effect against.

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